

Canadian History





About the Course

Read about Canadian history from 1800-1900 through a variety of texts: engaging narratives, history spines, primary source documents, and historical fiction. These books, which offer a range of perspectives, will immerse students in the time period and allow them to see the world through the eyes of those who lived it. Students will view images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts and Book of Centuries as appropriate for student level.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

This course is the same for students in grades 5 and 6. In grade 5, students may begin their Book of Centuries. It could be easily modified for students in grade 4, if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-6	Canadian History: Grades 5-6 1 time/week 25 min	The Story of Canada Tecumseh The Loxleys and Confederation Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 5-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Canadian History: Grades 5-6

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune is a historical novel that recounts the brave rescue of sailors from the HMS Tribune by a thirteen-year old boy known only as "Joe Cracker" to history. The author Jacqueline Halsey imagines a backstory for him, and parents may wish to pre-read the reveal of Joe's parentage on page 145-146 in advance to decide what is best for your particular student(s), especially those on the younger end of the age range. While the circumstances of Joe's birth, and the small boat he later uses in his rescue, both caused the fracturing of a family, Joe himself and the boat are what ultimately mend and heal the remaining family members. Some may choose to read the story aloud to edit on the fly if needed and to encourage discussion. Others will be fine with the content as is. We encourage all to provide an inviting space for students to ask questions and share thoughts as they process what they are reading in their books. There is always the option of substituting for Belle of Batoche from Grades 2-4 or Jeremy's War from Grades 7-8.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Canadian History: Grades 5-6



The Story of Canada



Tecumseh



The Loxleys and Confederation



Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Canadian History: Grades 5-6

∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Canadian History: Grades 5-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a

student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

Canadian History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 1

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune, Canadian atlas or map of Nova Scotia

→ INTRO

The years 1800-1900 were a momentous century for the history of Canada. It saw wars, rebellions, large waves of immigration, new and expanded settlements, exploration to the west and north, and Canada's Confederation of 1867, with more provinces and territories joining in the decades that followed. This course uses the narrative history *The Story of Canada* to provide an overview of the major events of the years 1800-1900, and a historical novel, a picture book, and a graphic novel to immerse students in three distinct moments in time: life in a fishing village on Nova Scotia's Chebucto Peninsula at the turn of the century, the life of Tecumseh, a Shawnee chief and British army ally in the War of 1812, and the Confederation Conferences of 1864, where the wheels of Canada's Confederacy were set in motion.

The first book, *Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune*, tells the story of a thirteen-year old boy who risked his life to save drowning sailors from the wreck of the H.M.S. Tribune, off the coast of Nova Scotia. This historical fiction novel imagines a backstory for the boy only known to history as "Joe Cracker," and it paints a detailed picture of what life was like in a small fishing village around 1800.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-13 "Wisps of fog" - "all about the ocean."

- Who are the characters you meet as the novel opens? How are they related to each other? What are they like?

You may choose to keep a character list with some notes.

→ MAP WORK

Map Resources: Canadian Student Atlas p. or any other map (including online) showing Nova Scotia.

Locate Halifax and the Chebucto Peninsula. Does your map show Herring Cove?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Explore Herring Cove

Watch a video tour of Herring Cove with Senator Stan Kutcher. If you're short on time, feel free to skip 1:58-2:54. This whole video could be saved for another point in the course, but it touches on many themes of the novel, so it's definitely not a video to miss!

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please read the header pages for this course which lists the page numbers for the sensitive content you may wish to preview.

WEEK 2

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 2

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the opening chapters of the novel?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13 "I broke my arm" - "Next job, Eli's shed."

- As you read, compare Joe's daily life to yours. For example, have you or anyone in your family ever broken a bone? How was it treated? How was Joe's treatment different? Or, what are your chores in the morning? Are they similar or different to Joe's?

WEEK 3

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 3

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.24-35 "Eli's derelict old shed" - "Nothing would burn today."

- As you learn more about the characters, add to your list or chart.

WEEK 4

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 4

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you learn from last week's reading about Gram?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.36-47 "Buttoned into his oilskins" - "mend a holey rowboat."

- Continue adding to your list of characters.

• EXTRA HELPING

Try making your own chicken and potato pasties, like Joe had in his lunch.

∞ **Recipe Link:** Chicken and Vegetable Pasties

Canadian History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ VIEW

Learn more about what killicks are and how they were made.
∞ Video Link: Making a Killick Anchor

WEEK 5

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 5

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading about the types of work Joe has to do?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48-60 "Ten long days of tides" - "to the old shed."

• Earlier in the novel, we learned that Joe has never been to school. This was not unusual two hundred years ago, when children were often needed to work inside or outside the home to help support their families. Why do you think Joe has never been to school? How does he learn what he needs to know?

WEEK 6

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 6

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading about the mystery of the skiff?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-72 "The old shed smelled" - "'when he saw the skiff," said Joe."

WEEK 7

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 7

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-84 "The next evening" - "Joe really really hoped so."

• How has medicine and medical care changed from Joe's time to ours? What are some differences? Are there any similarities?

WEEK 8

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 8

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What details or events stood out to you from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.85-97 "Gram was better" - "It should all work out."

Do you have any predictions for what will happen on Race Day?

• Remember to keep adding information to your character chart.

WEEK 9

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 9

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.98-110 "Joe ate his porridge" - "weren't meant to be."

• Keep adding to your character list as you learn more about the character in the story.

WEEK 10

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 10

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Race Day from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.111-124 "Winter arrived that night" - "Frederick lagged behind."

★ TEACHER TIP

Today's reading is a bit longer than the others, so you may want to leave extra time, or finish the reading in the afternoon.



Term 1

- What has happened to the Tribune? Why won't the captain receive assistance from either other Navy ships or the local fishermen?

→ VIEW

Look at this painting by maritime painter Thomas Whitcombe (1763-1824) of the Capture of the Tribune in 1796 by the British Navy. The Tribune was originally part of the French navy before its capture. What do you notice in the painting about these types of ships called frigates?

WEEK 11

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 11

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week about the Tribune's predicament?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.125-136 "It was toasty warm" - "He'd never know."

- What do you predict is going to happen? Why do you think Gram told Joe his father's name in this moment?
- Remember to continue adding to your character list as you learn more about the characters.

→ READ & DISCUSS

1. Read an account of the wreck of the Tribune from Nova Scotia's Maritime Museum of the Atlantic.

∞ Article Link: HMS Tribune - 1797

2. Read a second account of the wreck, taken from contemporary sources. Numerous details from the novel appear in this account - can you identify some of them?

∞ Article Link: Tribune

WEEK 12

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 12

Exams

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Canadian History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 13

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last time about the Tribune's predicament and Joe's plan?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

137-150 "It took three goes" - "Knowing always changes things," said Nettie."

- What was the result of Joe's rescue? Why does the town think of him as a hero?
- How did the author use the few details that can be found in the historical archive about the wreck of the Tribune to expand and enrich the story?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the sensitive content on page 145-146.

WEEK 2

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 14

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What details were most vivid from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.151-169 "The next weeks passed" - "come from my imagination."

- What are Joe's impressions of Halifax? While Halifax is only fifteen kilometres from Herring Cove (and about a 20 minute car trip), this would be a great distance to someone like Joe in 1797.
- Why did Joe decide to stay in Herring Cove, and why do you think he chose a pair of corduroy pants as a reward? Why do you think that detail stuck out so vividly to the author?
- What did you think of the novel?

→ VIEW

Look at images of the monument to the HMS Tribune at Joe Cracker.

Joe Cracker Joseph Shortt HMS Tribune

∞ Link: Joe Cracker Joseph Shortt HMS Tribune

WEEK 3

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 15

Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

Materials: Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune

→ RECAP

What do you remember about what happened after Joe's rescue from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.162-169 "A woman bustled up" - "come from my imagination."

- Why did Joe decide to stay in Herring Cove, and why do you think he chose a pair of corduroy pants as a reward? Why do you think that detail stuck out so vividly to the author?
- What did you think of the novel?

★ TEACHER TIP

In order to finish the novel, today's reading is longer than the others, so you may want to leave extra time, finish the reading in the afternoon, or find another time to read the Author's Note and view the monument.

WEEK 4

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 16

The War of 1812

Materials: The Story of Canada; Atlas or map of Canada

→ INTRO

In Joe and the Wreck of the Tribune, when Joe gets a tour of a Navy ship, the sailor Jacko tells him "We's at war, you know." The British Navy had been engaged in naval conflicts for much of the eighteenth century and continued until peace was declared in 1815 after the Battle of Waterloo. One of Britain's last major battles before 1815 was the War of 1812, which involved Canada. We will learn more about this war, and why it was significant for Canada's history, over the next few weeks.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.78-81 "Britain and the United States" - "British North America would stay British."

p.92 and 94 (skip page 93) "A few years later" - "into the North."

→ MAP WORK

Using a map of Ontario or Canada, locate Queenston Heights (near Niagara Falls), Detroit, Toronto (called York in 1812), Montreal, the St. Lawrence River, and the Great Lakes (Lake Ontario, Lake Erie, Lake Huron, Lake Michigan, and Lake Superior).

→ VIEW

1. Spend some time looking at this engraving of The Battle of Queenston Heights. The original engraving this one is based on is attributed to Captain James Dennis, who fought in the battle. The Americans (in blue) are crossing the Niagara River to Queenston (the right side) from Lewiston (the left side).

∞ Image Link: The Battle of Queenston Heights

• IMPORTANT DATES

Tecumseh (1768-1813)
Sir Isaac Brock (1769-1812)
War of 1812 (1812)

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch a Heritage Minute about how the Grand River warriors helped to defeat the Americans at Queenston Heights after the death of General Brock.

∞ Video Link: Heritage Minutes: Queenston Heights

Canadian History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

2. Visit Brock's Monument at Queenston Heights. You don't need to watch the whole video, but the drone footage provides an amazing view!
∞ Video Link: Canada's Most Imposing War Memorial

WEEK 5 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 17

Tecumseh

Materials: Tecumseh

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

WEEK 6 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 18

Tecumseh, cont.

Materials: Tecumseh

→ RECAP

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

WEEK 7 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 19

Tecumseh, cont.

Materials: Tecumseh

→ RECAP

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

WEEK 8 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 20

The Métis & The Red River Settlement

Materials: The Story of Canada; map or atlas of Canada that includes Manitoba

→ INTRO

While the War of 1812 was at its height in Upper and Lower Canada to the east, a Scottish nobleman named Thomas Douglas, 5th Earl of Selkirk, was working to establish a colony on the prairies to the west, at the intersection of the Red and Assiniboine Rivers, near what is now Winnipeg. Selkirk had received a large grant of land from the Hudson Bay Company and wanted to create a farming community to support many poor Scottish highlanders and Irish peasants, who had lost their homes and livelihoods due to various upheavals at the end of the eighteenth century. This community, known as the Red River Settlement, would come to play a large role in the history of immigrants to the prairies, Métis peoples, the province of Manitoba, and the history of Canada as a nation.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.114-120 "In April 1806" - "cries of despair."

→ MAPPING ACTIVITY

Look at a map or atlas of Manitoba (online is fine) and locate the Red River and Fort Douglas (present-day Winnipeg). Find the Hudson Bay on the same map so you can see the route the settlers took.

Compare this modern map to a map of the land given to Selkirk:

∞ Map Link: Map showing the Selkirk Land Grant in 1811

→ VIEW

Learn more about elements of Métis culture, several of which are mentioned in today's reading: Métis sash, Red River cart, Red River jig, Métis flag, cuisine, beadwork, and fiddle. Follow the "Learn More" links under each heading.

∞ Link: Symbols of Métis Culture

WEEK 9 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 21

Immigration to Canada

Materials: The Story of Canada

→ INTRO

What do you know about your own family's history in Canada? Where did your ancestors come from? Where did they settle? Where in Canada do you live now?

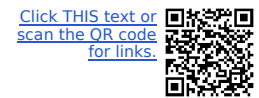
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83 "Grosse Ile is a beautiful island" - "their home was destroyed."

• EXTRA HELPING

Read excerpts from letters Catharine Parr Traill sent to her mother detailing her first impressions of Canada in 1832.
∞ **Link:** From Catharine Parr Traill, The Backwoods of Canada

Canadian History: Grades 5-6



Term 2

WEEK 10

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 22

Rebellion and Reform

Materials: The Story of Canada

→ RECAP

What did you read about immigration to Canada in the early nineteenth century?

→ INTRO

How do we choose our government in Canada and in our provinces and territories? Do you think it has always been this way in Canada? Today we will learn about frustrations towards the government in the 1830s, which would eventually lead to the form of government we recognize today.

→ VIEW

Remember that in 1791, the large Province of Quebec was divided into Upper and Lower Canada, roughly corresponding to the provinces of Ontario and Quebec today.

∞ Link: Upper & Lower Canada in 1791

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.93 "Bytown and Ottawa"

p.94-97 "In the 1830s" - "disguised in women's clothing"

- What changes did William Lyon Mackenzie want to see in Upper Canada?

• EXTRA HELPING

View more artwork by Cornelius Krieghoff.

∞ **Image Link:** Cornelius Krieghoff at the National Gallery of Canada

• IMPORTANT DATES

Louis-Joseph Papineau (1786-1871)

William Lyon Mackenzie (1795-1861)

WEEK 11

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 23

British North America

Materials: The Story of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about the rebellions in Upper and Lower Canada? What were their grievances?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.97-101 "Again, British North America" - "might be possible?"

- How did the system of Responsible Government change the way British North America was governed?

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch two Heritage Minutes about the reforms that were brought about by the rebellions in the 1830s:

∞ **Video Link:** Heritage Minutes: Baldwin & LaFontaine (Parents may wish to preview this one for younger students since it does dramatize a violent scene)

∞ **Video Link:** Heritage Minutes: Responsible Government Queen Victoria voices her approval of the reforms.

The sailing ship Marco Polo met its fate in a storm off the coast of Cavendish, and its running aground was witnessed by a young L.M. Montgomery, who later wrote an essay about it for the Montreal Daily Witness (March 5, 1891). You can read her essay [here](#).

∞ **PDF Link:** The Wreck of the Marco Polo

WEEK 12

25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 24

Exams

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

The Story of Canada

Canadian History: Grades 5-6

Click [THIS text](#) or
scan the QR code
for links.



Term 3		
WEEK 1	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 25	
WEEK 2	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 26 C	
WEEK 3	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 27 D	
WEEK 4	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 5	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 6	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 31 D	
WEEK 8	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 9	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 35 C	
WEEK 12	 25m Canadian History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 36	

Canadian History: Grades 5-6

Examination

Term 1

- Describe what life was like in Herring Cove, Nova Scotia around 1800; consider historical details such as food, shelter, clothing, transportation, medical care, family life, communication, etc.